

The IMO logo consists of the letters "IMO" in white, bold, sans-serif font, centered within an orange rounded square.

IMO

Integration
Management
Office

We make it happen!



Master Integration Framework

The **DRIVE** Model — Firstsource Edition

- World-class M&A frameworks
- Informed by Firstsource integration experience
- Failure points as guardrails
- The Firstsource Playbook

Deepinder Singh Bhatia | Global Head of Integrations | 2026

The Case for an IMO

70–90%

**Global M&A
Fail Rate**

due to poor integration execution

∞

Value at Risk

without a structured IMO from Day 1

Day 1

**When the IMO
must be live**

not week 3 — not after signing

Global Best Practice

- McKinsey: IMO-led governance, synergy baseline pre-close, 100-Day plan
- BCG: Fast-to-value acceleration, named owners, integration health index
- Kearney: Clean room protocol, regulatory gating, maturity scorecards
- Deloitte: Culture-first model, people moments, retention risk mapping
- PMBOK / Prince2: Governance rigour, tollgates, formal decision logs

Firstsource Experience

2

- Org design convergence must be time-boxed — open timelines leak value
- Culture integration requires a named, funded workstream owner from Day 1
- IT target-state architecture must be decided before close — not post Day 1
- HR policies applied uniformly — exceptions create compliance and equity risk
- Revenue and Cost synergies must be structured, tracked and owned — not assumed

What Firstsource Learned the Hard Way

Four acquisitions · One consistent theme: synergies assumed, culture deferred, value leaked · Every guardrail in DRIVE exists because of what happened here

Past Due

Data & Analytics BPO

WHAT FAILED

- PD capabilities siloed — never leveraged for non-collections cross-sell
- Platform integration to FSL deprioritised — cost & revenue synergies delayed
- Advanced analytics & AI not deployed to expand FSL client base

LESSON

Revenue synergy from data assets requires a named AI-tracked owner and 90–180 day activation plan from Day 1

Ascensos

BPO Retail Acquisition

WHAT FAILED

- Parallel cost structures ran too long — cost model not reset within 90 days
- Brand sunset delayed ~24 months — identity confusion, cultural damage
- No culture integration owner — legacy ways of working persisted throughout

LESSON

Brand and culture cannot be deferred — fund and name them on Day 1, not Month 12

TeleMedik

Healthcare BPO

WHAT FAILED

- Revenue fell from \$4M to \$3.7M post-integration — synergy case not protected
- Overemphasis on cost synergies at the direct expense of revenue retention
- Client relationship continuity not actively managed through the transition

LESSON

Never allow integration activity to degrade existing revenue — SLA continuity and AI client-risk monitoring are non-negotiable from Day 1

QBSS

Finance & Business Services

WHAT FAILED

- Earn-out targets missed — key leaders departed as a direct consequence
- Cost synergy benefits not fully realised at programme close
- Dual systems and reporting formats persisted — no decommission roadmap enforced

LESSON

Earn-out requires explicit AI synergy tracking from Day 1, not retrospective validation

01

Time-box all convergence decisions — 90 days max, no exceptions

02

Culture Lead appointed Day 1 — funded, named, reports to IMO Lead

03

IT target-state at due diligence — AI decommission roadmap by Day 45

04

Every synergy line: named owner, AI baseline, milestone, CFO cadence

05

HR policies: defined dates, zero exceptions, end-to-end from Day 1

06

Client contracts audited pre-close — Tier 1 calls within 48hrs of Day 1

From Live Deal to Better Framework — 8 aspects from TeleMedik experience that inform the proposed DRIVE framework

LESSONS → FRAMEWORK

DEAL REALITY — WHAT TELEMEDIC SHOWED

Earn-Out as Governance Tool

Telemedik: dual trigger (Revenue + EBITDA), offset via lease credits, \$500K overachievement tranche →

Strategic Override Protocol

Telemedik: top 3 clients = 78% revenue (red flag by Tier 1 criteria) — proceeded with compensating controls →

Govt Incentive Optimisation

Telemedik: Puerto Rico Act 60 tax incentives, URAC accreditation, dual-jurisdiction legal (Indi + US lawyers) →

Market Necessity / Build-vs-Buy

Telemedik: \$32Bn US payer outsourcing market, MLR at 90%, competitor M&A acceleration - urgency not in target financials →

Customer-Confirmed Pipeline Pre-Close

Telemedik: FSL met clients pre-close, confirmed \$18.3M CY2026 pipeline before signing — not after →

Role-Level SG&A Map as DD Output

Telemedik: 17 named roles identified for downsizing/offshoring in DD — Day 1 actions pre-approved before close →

Clinical & Compliance Workstream

Telemedik: UM/CM/DM, care coordination, telehealth, URAC since 2001, 12 payer operating model domains →

Founder Transition Protocol

Telemedik: Dr. Fernandez (founder 1997) — clinical credibility and Puerto Rico ecosystem relationships are strategic assets →

FRAMEWORK IMPROVEMENT — WHERE IT NOW LIVES

V — Value slide · Integration Charter: earn-out KPI design, dual triggers, offset structures, CFO quarterly review

Tier 1 Framework: 7th lens added · Override requires Board sign-off + IMO activated 30 days earlier

R — Readiness · Tier 2 Pre-Close Gate: incentive plan as mandatory DD deliverable, not just compliance

Tier 1: 7th lens — TAM, competitive pressure, build timeline, buy vs build cost comparison

Tier 2 Pre-Close Gate: customer-confirmed pipeline now MANDATORY, not best practice

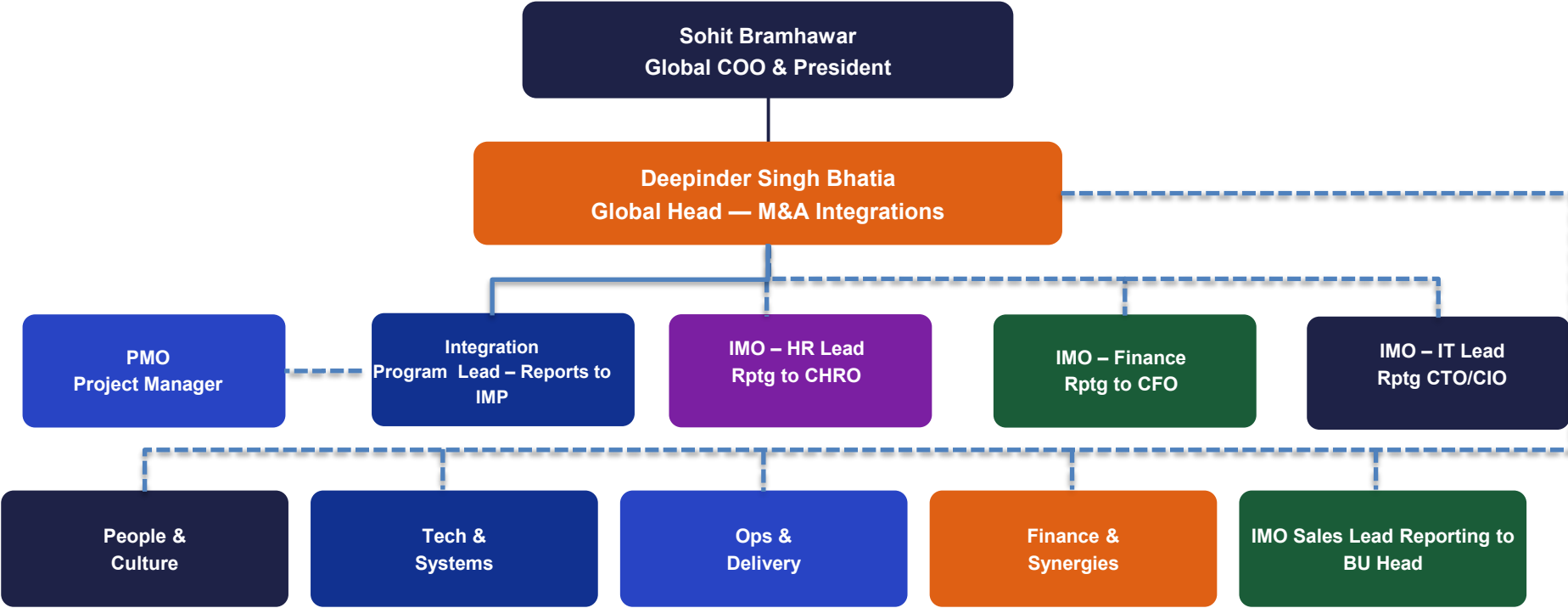
D — Direction · Tollgate 2: SG&A map with named roles, functions, and CEO-approved Day 1 actions required

I — Integration Engine: Workstream 06 (Clinical & Compliance) activated for healthcare vertical acquisitions

People Workstream: formal 90-day Founder Transition Plan, knowledge transfer protocol, advisory role definition

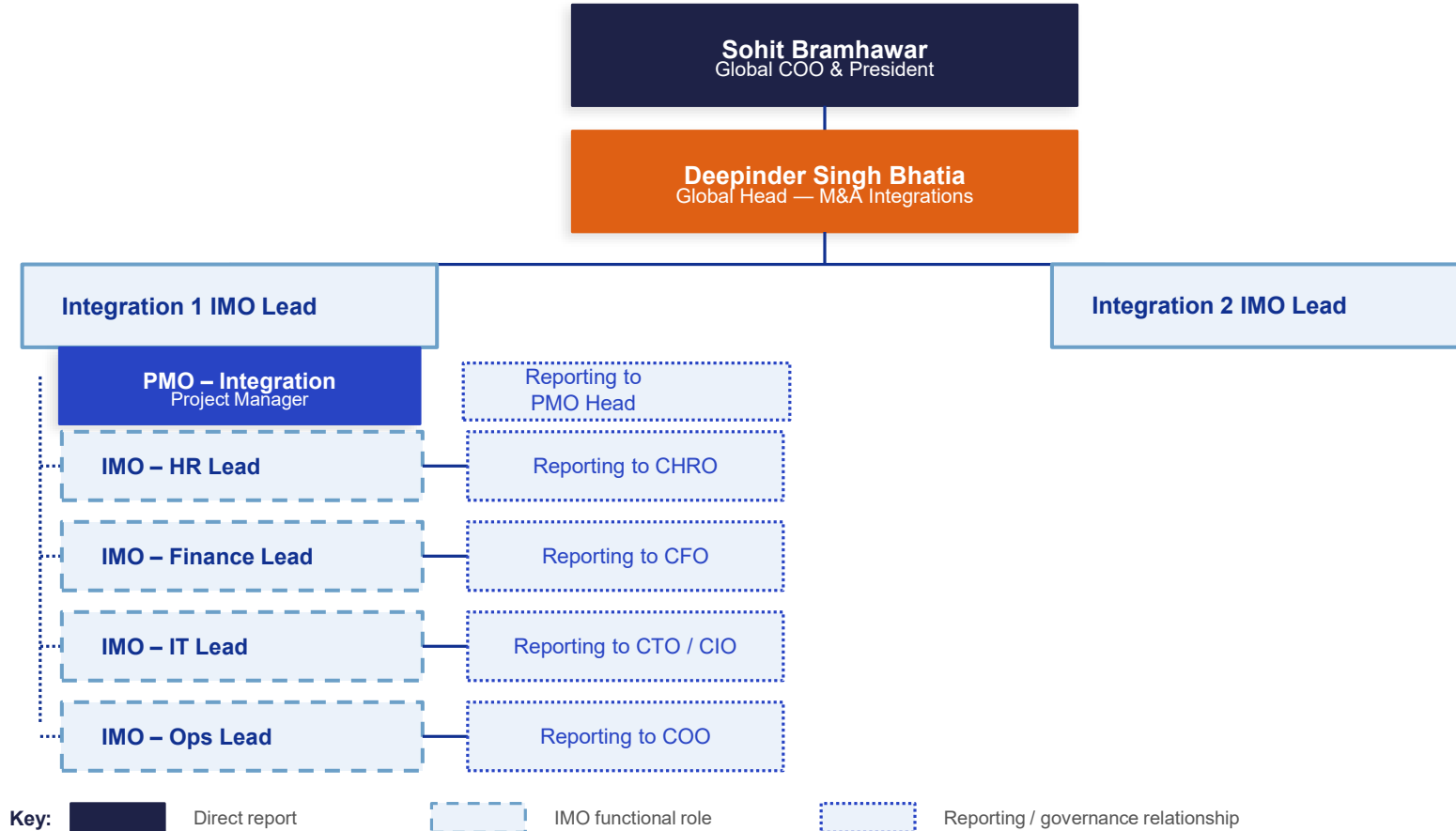
Global M&A Integration Management Office — Organisation

Effective 1 July 2026 · Deepinder Singh Bhatia, Global Head — M&A Integrations



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Effective 1 July 2026



Section 2 : “DRIVE” IMO Framework and Playbook

We make it happen.

The DRIVE Integration Framework

Purpose-built for complex acquisitions · Underpinned by McKinsey · BCG · Kearney · Deloitte

D

DIRECTION

Strategy & Vision

- IMO charter & mandate
- Deal thesis alignment
- Synergy baseline (pre-close)
- Stakeholder & risk map

R

READINESS

Day 1 Preparation

- Clean room protocol
- Day 1 war room
- Legal & regulatory gating
- Client continuity plan

I

INTEGRATION

Execution Engine

- Functional workstream, named leads
- Weekly IMO cadence
- RAG governance model
- Adopt vs adapt decisions

V

VALUE

Synergy Capture

- Cost synergy ledger
- Revenue pipeline (A/B/C)
- CFO-owned dashboard
- Waterfall bridge tracking

E

EMBED

Culture & BAU

- Culture lead — Day 1
- TOM transition
- Retention programme
- BAU handover & close

Underpinned by: IMO · Synergy Tracker · Culture Lead · Change & Comms · Regulatory Clean Room · IT Architecture Decision

D

DIRECTION

Strategy
& Vision

D — Direction: Strategy, Charter & Synergy Baseline

IMO Charter & Mandate

- Formal charter signed by CEO & CFO before Day 1
- Dedicated BU / PMO IMO Leads, reports to Global IMO Head
- Authority levels defined — what IMO can decide vs escalate
- Integration Steering Committee constituted at signing

Deal Thesis & Synergy Baseline

- Deal thesis translated into integration priorities
- Synergy baseline set pre-close — cost AND revenue
- Every synergy line: named owner, baseline, milestone
- CFO co-owns synergy tracker from Day 1

Stakeholder & Org Map

- Full stakeholder map: FSL + Target + clients + regulators
- Leadership retention risk identified within 48 hours
- Decision rights mapped — who decides what, by when
- Top 30 talent flagged for personal retention calls

Integration Principles

- 'Adopt vs adapt' framework agreed pre-close
- All convergence decisions time-boxed: 90 days maximum
- Client SLAs protected — zero disruption is non-negotiable
- IT target-state architecture signed off at due diligence

TOLLGATE 2 DELIVERABLE — Due Diligence Output Required Before Signing: Role-level SG&A reduction map (named roles, functions, Day 1 actions pre-approved by CEO) · Vendor renegotiation targets identified · Govt incentive optimisation plan filed

R

READINESS

Day 1 Preparation

R — Readiness: Clean Room, War Room & Day 1 Protocol

Clean Room Protocol

- Pre-close data exchange governed by legal gating
- Regulatory clearance checklist — HIPAA, URAC, sector-specific
- Sensitive data ring-fenced; clean team defined
- Change-of-control clauses audited in all client contracts

Day 1 War Room

- War room pre-built: owners, contact cascade, scripts
- CEO-led all-hands within 24 hours of close
- Tier 1 client calls within 48 hours — no exceptions
- Top 30 talent retention calls on Day 1

Communications Plan

- Internal comms: people-first, before external
- External GTM: unified brand narrative from Day 1
- Biweekly integration mailers launched at close
- Media and analyst briefing plan prepared pre-close

Regulatory & Legal Gating

- All regulatory approvals tracked on a live gating log
- Government incentive structures identified at diligence
- Entity structure decisions made before close
- BCP & RTO/RPO frameworks aligned to critical business lines

I — Integration Engine: Five Workstreams & Named Accountability

01

People & Culture

Org design convergence time-boxed · Leadership alignment · Role clarity & decision rights · Culture integration owner — Day 1 · SuccessFactors & HR policy adoption

02

Technology & Systems

Target-state architecture pre-close · Decommission roadmap by Day 45 · Platform consolidation (Kairos-first) · Data security & access governance · Clinical/sector system integration

03

Operations & Delivery

TOM designed and signed off · WFM capacity planning · SOP harmonisation · Vendor consolidation · Reporting layer (Power BI) stood up

04

Finance & Synergies

SAP/ERP integration · Client-level P&L visibility · Synergy tracker live from Day 1 · FP&A reporting: manual → system-driven · Benefits funnel: Identified → Committed → Realised

05

Sales & Commercial

Unified GTM and pricing · Cross-sell pipeline structured (Bucket A/B/C) · CRM & Salesforce CPQ integration · Bundle strategy and capability deck · Commercial governance — single escalation path

06

Clinical & Compliance

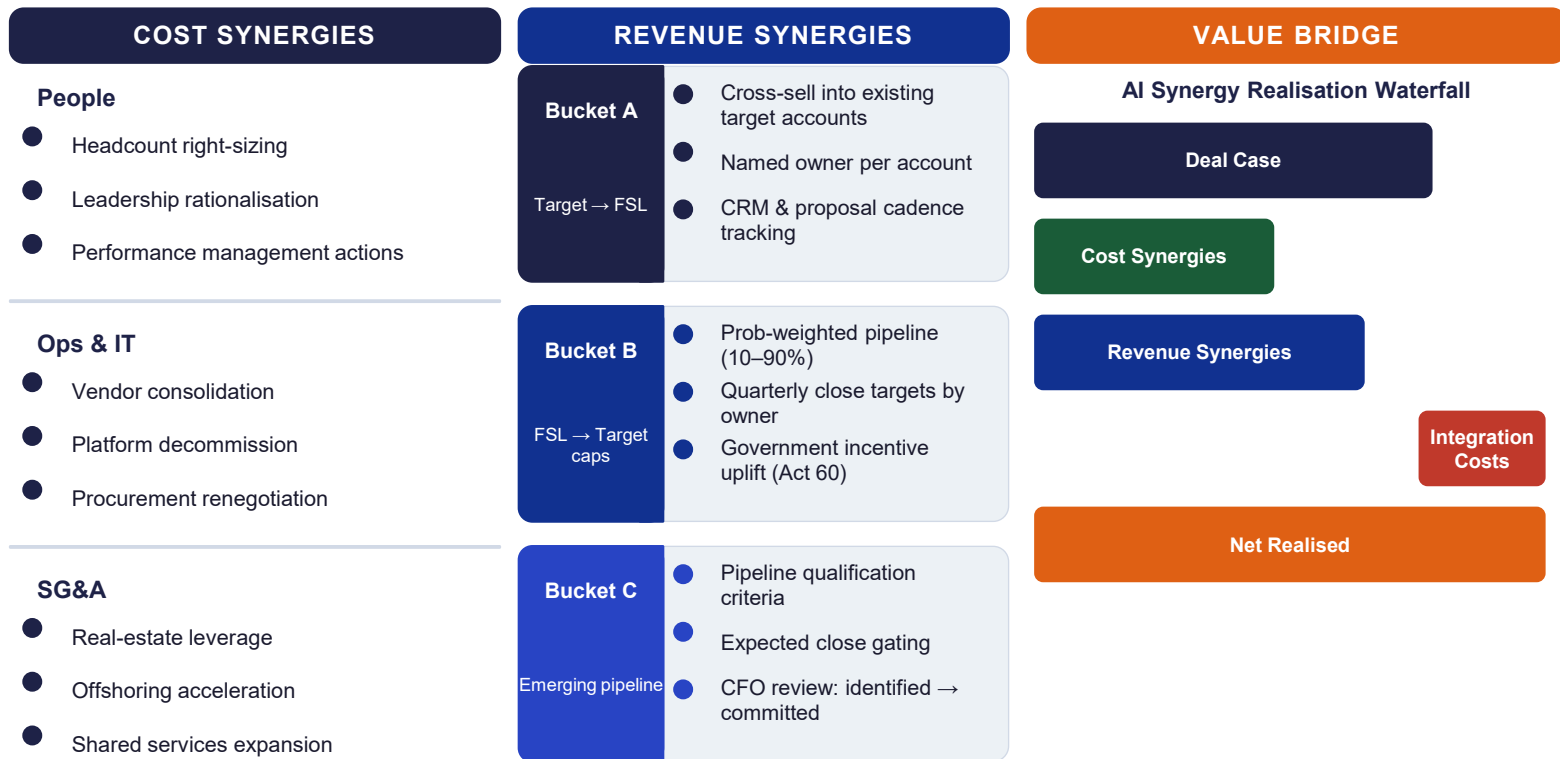
[Healthcare vertical] URAC/HIPAA accreditation continuity · UM/CM/DM programme integration · Telehealth platform · Care coordination · Founder/clinical lead transition plan · Govt incentive (Act 60) optimization



VALUE

Synergy
Capture

V — Value: Synergy Architecture — Cost · Revenue · Value Realisation



Benefits Funnel · Identified → Committed → Realised (AI-validated by Finance) · Cadence: Monthly · Owner: CFO + IMO

EARN-OUT MECHANICS · Design earn-out as a governance tool, not just a payment mechanism · Dual trigger (Revenue AND EBITDA margin) prevents gaming · Overachievement tranche aligns seller to long-term growth · Offset structures (lease credits, receivables) reduce Day 1 cash risk · CFO-validated quarterly against deal model milestones

E

EMBED

Culture
& BAU

E — Embed: Culture Assimilation, TOM Transition & BAU Handover

Culture Integration Lead

- Named, funded workstream — not a People side task
- Reports directly to CHRO & COO, works closely with IMO
- Culture diagnostic commissioned at due diligence
- Legacy practices sunset with defined deadlines

Target Operating Model

- TOM designed and signed off in Stabilise phase
- Single P&L accountability: revenue + cost + quality
- Vendor and shared services consolidation complete
- AI reporting layer — account-level P&L visibility

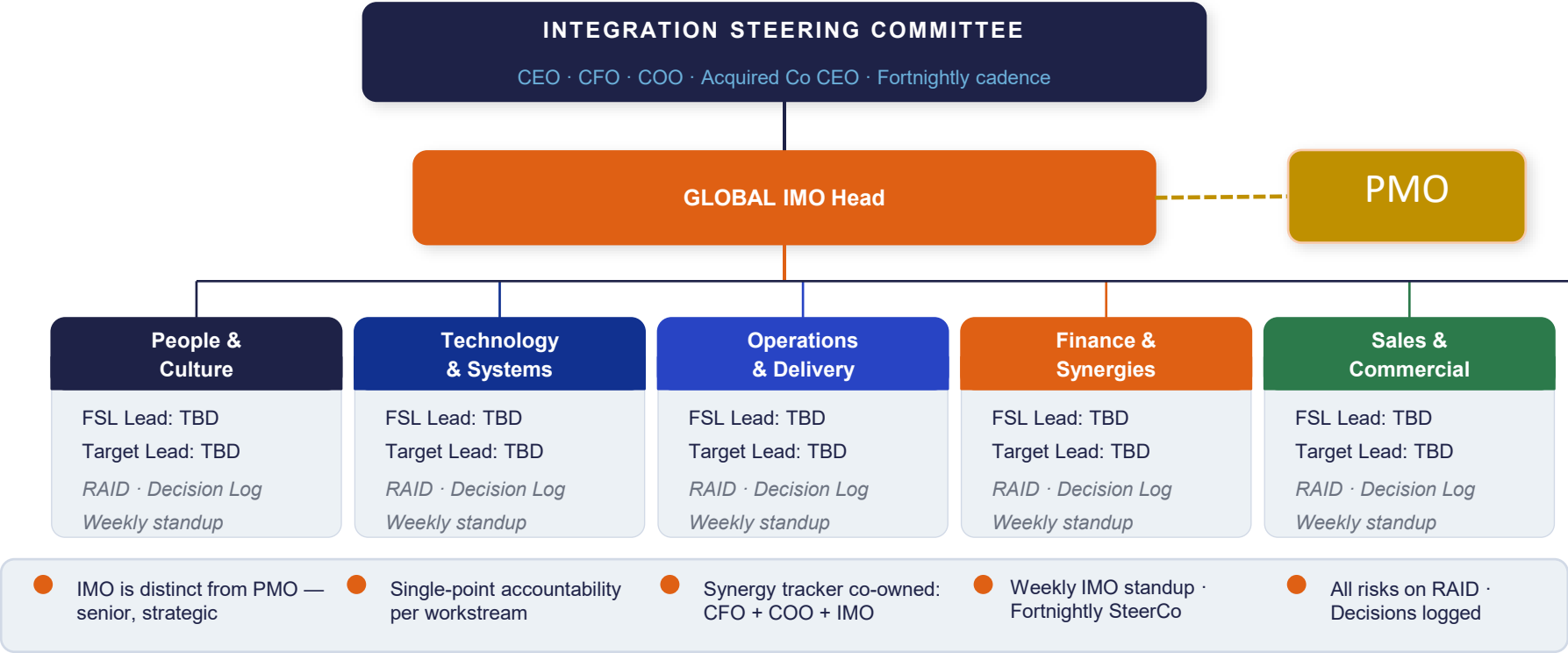
AI-Powered Talent Retention

- Attrition target: <12% (vs industry 18%)
- AI predicts flight-risk talent — personal calls on Day 1
- Single compensation bands harmonised by Month 6
- Leadership structure announced — no ambiguity by Day 30

BAU Handover & Close

- Integration formally closed with board sign-off
- AI lessons registry updated — guardrails for next deal
- Entity consolidation proposed where applicable
- Earn-out reconciled to deal model — CFO validated

IMO Governance Model



Integration Lifecycle — 6-Phase Model with Tollgates

Pre-deal strategy through to BAU — every phase gate requires formal IMO sign-off before proceeding · AI-augmented at every phase · No exceptions



TG = Tollgate · Formal IMO sign-off required before any phase proceeds · No exceptions · All milestones verified by PM during Level 3 Project Governance Reviews

100-Day Integration Plan — BPO Specific

BCG & McKinsey 100-Day Acceleration Protocol · Hardened by QBSS and Ascensos experience · AI-augmented at every milestone

DAY 1–10	DAY 11–30	DAY 31–70	DAY 71–100
● Activate IMO war room — not PMO ● CEO-led all-hands: set tone from the top ● Personal retention calls to top 30 talent ● Client calls: every Tier 1 client within 48hrs ● Freeze org changes for 30 days ● AI activates clean IT separation protocols	● Make all adopt vs adapt decisions — document them ● Announce leadership structure — no ambiguity ● AI launches employee integration sentiment survey ● Establish AI synergy baseline with CFO ● Agree IT target-state architecture ● Finalise combined service catalogue	● Implement quick-win cost synergies ● Re-badge and transition HR policies — no exceptions ● Launch unified performance framework ● Begin process standardisation (Ops) ● Client comms — combined value proposition ● AI confirms technology platform decision	● 100-Day review to Steering Committee ● AI synergy capture dashboard — update vs plan ● Operating model v1.0 signed off ● Culture integration pulse check ● Phase 2 integration plan baselined ● IMO AI health dashboard published

QBSS lesson: leadership alignment took too long — announce structure by Day 30, not Day 90 · Ascensos lesson: HR policy exceptions created compliance gaps — zero exceptions from Day 1 · AI flags any slip vs plan automatically

Culture Integration & Change Management

The #1 cause of integration failure — no culture owner was appointed in QBSS or Ascensos. That changes now.

Culture Diagnostic (Pre-Close)	People Moments that Matter	Integration Ambassadors	AI Retention Risk Mapping
● Values & behaviours mapping ● Leadership style comparison ● Decision-making model gap ● Employee engagement baseline ● Brand identity assessment	● Announcement day experience ● First day and onboarding journey ● Manager communication protocols ● Total rewards alignment ● Career path clarity	● 50/50 mixed teams appointed ● Both entities equally represented ● Monthly ambassador forum ● Two-way feedback loop to IMO ● AI-monitored escalation channel	● AI identifies top 100 critical talent ● Individual retention agreements ● AI-powered 30/60/90 day stay interviews ● Flight risk early warning system ● Weekly tracker to HR Lead
⚠ Neither QBSS nor Ascensos ran a pre-close culture diagnostic — decisions were made blind	⚠ Ascensos: colleagues learned about brand sunset from rumour, not structured comms	⚠ No ambassador network in either deal — legacy practices persisted for lack of champions	⚠ QBSS: critical role dependencies not mapped early — led to slower decision flow

Culture integration is a named, funded, IMO-owned workstream — not a People workstream. A dedicated Culture Lead + AI sentiment monitoring is required from Day 1.

Pre-Acquisition Intelligence Framework

TIER 1 OF 2

Should we acquire? · Seven AI-benchmarked lenses · All must clear before deal decision — or a Strategic Override Protocol is activated

01 Financial Health

EBITDA margin · Revenue trajectory · Net Debt/EBITDA · Free cash flow · Working capital

EBITDA >12–15% · Net Debt <3× EBITDA · Revenue CAGR >5% (3yr) · FCF >70%

Bain Capital M&A Screen · McKinsey Deal Qualification Standard

Red flag: EBITDA <8% — no credible path to 12%+ within 24 months post-close

02 Revenue Quality

Recurring vs project mix · Client concentration · Contract tenor · NRR & churn

>70% recurring · No single client >25% · Avg contract >2 yrs · Churn <10%

BCG M&A Revenue Durability Framework · Gartner SaaS/BPO Revenue Health Model

Red flag: top 3 clients >50% revenue — concentration risk materialises at Day 1

03 Growth Trajectory

3yr revenue CAGR · Pipeline coverage · Market share direction · NRR · Win rate

>8% CAGR YoY · Pipeline >2× trailing revenue · NRR >100% · Win rate >25%

Kearney Organic Growth Health Index · PwC Deal Value Creation Study

Red flag: declining market share + pipeline <1.5× — structural, not cyclical

04 Operational Fitness

SLA performance · Attrition · Offshore ratio · Automation maturity · Margin walk

Attrition <20% · Offshore >35% BPO · SLA breach <2% · Automation >20%

Accenture BPO Operations Benchmark · Everest Group BPO Excellence Model

Red flag: attrition >25% + SLA breach >5% — integration accelerates both

05 Strategic Fit

Capability gaps · Geographic expansion · Client base access · Vertical diversification

3+ synergy categories validated · Client overlap <40% · Min 2 new geo markets

Deloitte M&A Strategic Fit Matrix · EY Deal Rationale Scorecard

Red flag: <2 synergy categories + >40% client overlap — value is duplication

06 Integration Complexity

IT landscape · Regulatory footprint · HR harmonisation gap · Multi-jurisdiction risk

Single ERP preferred · Multi-jurisdiction adds \$2–4M · HIPAA / URAC mapped

McKinsey Integration Complexity Scorecard · KPMG M&A Readiness Framework

Red flag: dual ERP + multi-jurisdiction + union labour = +18 months minimum

07 Market Necessity / Build-vs-Buy

Total addressable market · Competitive pressure · Capability gap · Build timeline · Cost to build

TAM >\$5Bn preferred · Build timeline >18 months = buy · Competitor M&A signals urgency

McKinsey M&A Rationale Screen · Bain Build-Buy-Partner Framework

Red flag: capability can be built in <12 months at <50% of acquisition cost — re-examine buy rationale

⚡ Strategic Override Protocol

When a deal fails one or more lenses but proceeds on strategic grounds, the following compensating controls are mandatory: (1) Failed lens documented + explicit Board sign-off (2) Earn-out dual-trigger tied to the failing metric (3) IMO activated 30 days earlier than standard timeline (4) Customer-confirmed pipeline submitted before close (5) Monthly CFO review until failing lens resolves

7 lenses cleared → proceed to Tier 2 · Any lens failed → activate Strategic Override Protocol before proceeding · Board sign-off required

Pre-Close & Day 1 Execution Gate

TIER 2 OF 2

How do we execute? · Mandatory IMO actions before signing and through the first 100 days · Orange = non-negotiable, no exceptions

PRE-CLOSE — Before Signing

Complete before binding documentation is signed. These are IMO activation steps — not post-close actions.

- Establish IMO — dedicated lead, reports to COO, senior to PMO
- Set synergy baseline — cost AND revenue, named owner per line
- IT target-state architecture signed off at due diligence
- Client contract audit — all change-of-control clauses identified
- HR policy adoption plan — defined dates, zero exceptions
- Day 1 war room built — call cascade, scripts, comms pack
- Culture diagnostic commissioned for target entity
- Org design end-state milestones set (Day 30 / 90 / 180)
- Regulatory & government incentive structures identified
- BCP and RTO/RPO aligned to critical business lines

DAY 1 → DAY 100 — Non-Negotiables

The first 100 days determine whether value is captured or permanently lost. Every orange item is a guardrail from prior deal failures.

- CEO-led all-hands within 24 hours of close — set the tone
- Tier 1 client calls — every key account within 48 hours
- Top 30 talent retention calls — personal, on Day 1
- Culture Lead active and embedded from Day 1 — not Month 3
- Adopt vs adapt decisions documented — all made by Day 30
- Leadership structure announced — zero ambiguity by Day 30
- IT decommissioning roadmap published — by Day 45
- Synergy quick wins identified and actioned — by Day 30
- Power BI / reporting layer MVP live — by Day 60
- Phase-gate exit: SteerCo sign-off on Stabilise phase

THREE ADDITIONAL MANDATORIES — Added from Telemedic / Firstsource live deal experience

- Customer-confirmed pipeline submitted pre-close
- Role-level SG&A reduction map — named roles, Day 1 actions approved
- Govt incentive optimisation plan (e.g. Act 60) — identified & integrated into deal model

Integration Charter — Terms of Reference

Reusable template — complete at signing for every acquisition. All fields mandatory.

Purpose & Value Targets

- Ensure seamless integration — protect customer trust and continuity
- Revenue Synergy target: \$[]M within 12 months (named owner)
- Cost Synergy target: \$[]M SG&A savings within 12 months
- EBITDA run-rate margin target: []% in 12 months / []% in 24 months

Governance & Reporting Cadence

- Executive SteerCo: CEO/CFO/CHRO/Sponsor · Fortnightly
- Working SteerCo: IMO Lead + Workstream Owners · Weekly
- Artefacts: RAID log · Decision log · Change control · SteerCo minutes
- Escalation: Workstream → Working SteerCo → Executive SteerCo

Core Integration Team

- Executive Sponsor: []
- IMO Lead: [] — dedicated, reports to COO
- PMO Lead: [] · Value Realisation Lead: Finance + BU
- Tech Lead: IT/data security · Change/Comms Lead: HR & culture

Success Criteria & KPIs

- Revenue synergies: cross-sell & upsell pipeline converted (monthly)
- Cost synergies: SG&A reduction via rightshoring, vendor, offshoring
- Benefits funnel: Identified → Committed → Realised (Finance-validated)
- Phase exits: SteerCo sign-off required · Earn-out: CFO-reconciled

IMO Setup Roadmap — Now to Operational

Three horizons to take Firstsource's IMO from established to fully deal-ready and AI-enabled

NOW

0–4 Weeks

Appoint Global IMO Lead

Dedicated; reports to COO — confirmed, active

Define IMO Charter

Mandate, remit, authority levels, PMO interface

Build IMO Team

Culture Lead, Synergy Lead, IT Integration Lead, Comms Lead

Create Governance Templates

Charter, RAID log, decision log, change control log

SOON

4–12 Weeks

Build the Playbook

DRIVE model + FSL lessons → operational playbook

Design AI Synergy Model

Cost + revenue baseline with AI auto-update — CFO co-owned

Build Clean Room Protocol

Pre-close data exchange, legal gating, regulatory checklist

Deploy AI Tracking Tools

Power BI synergy dashboard + RAG workstream monitor live

READY

Pre-Next Deal

Run IMO Simulation

Tabletop: Day 1 war room, client call cascade, comms drill

Integrate with Corp Dev

IMO in deal team from T-90 — not brought in post-signing

AI Health Scorecard Live

Integration health index + AI anomaly detection ready for board

Lessons Registry Live

All guardrails embedded in AI tools — updated after every deal

Next Steps: AI-Powered Synergy Tracking & Integration Automation

AI

Every stage of the integration lifecycle automated and AI-augmented — from synergy baselining to real-time value realisation and CFO reporting

01 Pre-Deal

AI screens targets: EBITDA trajectory, revenue quality, client concentration. NLP scans data rooms. Red flags surface automatically.

02 Due Diligence

AI maps AS-IS TOM. NLP extracts contracts, SLA clauses, change-of-control triggers. Culture sentiment analysis on employee data.

03 Day 1

AI-generated war room dashboard. Automated client risk scoring. Real-time comms drafting triggered by close event.

04 First 100 Days

AI tracks adopt vs adapt decisions. Sentiment monitoring. Attrition risk prediction for top 30. Synergy pipeline auto-updated.

05 Integration

AI monitors workstream RAG in real-time. Vendor deduplication. Process mining identifies inefficiency. Predictive cost savings.

06 BAU Close

AI reconciles deal model vs actual. CFO dashboard auto-populated. Lessons registry auto-generated from decision log.

STANDARDISED SYNERGY TRACKER — LIVE EXAMPLE

Synergy Line	Category	Owner	Baseline \$M	Committed \$M	Realised \$M	Status
Headcount rationalisation	Cost	CFO	2.1	2.1	1.8	ON TRACK
Vendor consolidation	Cost	COO	0.8	0.8	0.6	WATCH
Offshore acceleration	Cost	Ops	1.2	0.9	0.4	WATCH
Cross-sell — Bucket A	Revenue	CRO	4.5	3.2	1.1	ON TRACK
Cross-sell — Bucket B	Revenue	CRO	8.0	4.0	0.0	WATCH
SG&A real-estate	Cost	CFO	0.6	0.6	0.6	ON TRACK
Platform decommission	Cost	CTO	0.4	0.4	0.0	AT RISK
New GTM bundle	Revenue	CRO	3.0	1.0	0.0	WATCH
TOTAL		18.6	13.0	4.5		

⚡ AI auto-updates this tracker weekly from Power BI · Flags variance >10% · Escalates RED items to CFO and IMO Lead automatically

AI AUTOMATION STACK

Data Ingestion

Power BI · SAP/ERP · HRIS · CRM (Salesforce) · Contract management

AI Intelligence

NLP contract analysis · Sentiment monitoring · Attrition prediction · Revenue forecasting

Automation Engine

RAG auto-update · Variance alerts · Escalation triggers · Decision logging

Executive Dashboard

CFO synergy view · IMO health index · Real-time waterfall · Board-ready output

Governance Layer

Audit trail · Phase-gate validation · SteerCo pack auto-generated · IMO sign-off

AI amplifies IMO judgement — it does not replace it · Every AI output is validated by a named human owner before action · Governance is non-negotiable

3 Non-Negotiables

Lessons Firstsource learned the hard way — built into every element of DRIVE and enforced by AI

1

Standalone IMO appointed before Day 1

Not the PMO. Not a project manager. A dedicated, senior integration lead with a charter, a team, authority — and AI tools from Day 1.

2

Adopt vs adapt decisions made within 90 days

No open-ended timelines. Every convergence decision documented, AI-tracked and owned — no teams defaulting to legacy ways of working.

3

Culture integration is a funded, named workstream

Not a People side task. A dedicated Culture Lead from Day 1 — with budget, board visibility, and AI sentiment monitoring throughout.

D DIRECTION **R** READINESS **I** INTEGRATION **V** VALUE **E** EMBED

Deepinder Singh Bhatia | Global Head of M&A Integrations | Firstsource | 2026

Target Operating Model — AS-IS to TO-BE

APPENDIX · Five integration dimensions · Industry-informed transformation principles · BPO & healthcare services context

DIMENSION	AS-IS · FRAGMENTED STATE	→	TO-BE · INTEGRATED TARGET
Operating Model	● Dual P&L, two cost bases, two revenue lines in parallel ● Siloed leadership — no unified accountability ● Legacy ways persist — no adopt/adapt deadline set <i>DXC: Dual P&L 18 months post-merger — destroyed \$2B margin before forced consolidation</i>	→	● Single P&L — one leadership layer owns revenue, cost, quality ● Shared services operational: finance, HR, IT, procurement ● TOM signed off Day 45; all legacy structures sunset by Day 180 <i>Accenture BPO: shared services in 90 days — 22% SG&A reduction achieved</i>
Technology & Platforms	● Dual platform stacks — redundant licences, duplicate data ● No decommission roadmap; IT decisions deferred ● Clinical/sector systems not evaluated at due diligence <i>DXC: Two ERP stacks ran 24 months — \$400M in avoidable run costs</i>	→	● Single platform strategy confirmed pre-close at signing ● AI decommission roadmap live Day 45 — hard cutover date set ● Clinical/sector systems integrated or sunset with vendor exits <i>Microsoft × LinkedIn: unified data layer in Year 1 — preserved value while enabling cross-sell</i>
People & Culture	● Two org designs, two pay bands, two performance frameworks ● Culture integration has no named owner ● Attrition risk not mapped; retention calls not until Month 3+ <i>Ascensos: no culture owner 12 months — brand sunset delayed 18 months</i>	→	● Single org structure with harmonised bands by Month 6 ● Culture Lead appointed Day 1 — funded, reports to IMO Lead ● AI flags top 30 attrition risk on Day 1; target <12% vs 18% <i>Salesforce × Slack: retained Slack identity via dedicated lead; NPS +14pts</i>
Commercial & GTM	● Separate sales teams, fragmented pricing — no unified governance ● Cross-sell exists on paper — no named owner or pipeline ● Offerings presented independently — no bundled solutions <i>QBSS: revenue synergies assumed — never tracked or owned. Earn-out missed.</i>	→	● Unified GTM — one escalation path, one price book ● Cross-sell AI-tracked by bucket (A: target; B: FSL; C: emerging) ● Bundled offerings in market by Day 90; joint capability deck <i>Salesforce × Slack: embedded in Customer 360 within 9 months — \$1.5B cross-sell Year 1</i>
Finance & Reporting	● Manual FP&A — no client-level P&L; synergies tracked in aggregate ● Reporting on spreadsheets — no shared BI layer ● Benefits funnel undefined: identified vs realised not separated <i>QBSS: no synergy tracking from Day 1 — retrospective audit found synergies well below plan</i>	→	● AI-powered ERP reporting — client-level P&L visible from Month 3 ● Single Power BI layer with AI synergy dashboard — CFO-owned ● Benefits funnel: Identified → Committed → Realised, Finance-validated <i>Microsoft × LinkedIn: unified financial reporting in 6 months — \$3.8B attribution by Y2</i>

TOM transition is a governed programme with phase-gate exits, named owners and board-level visibility at every milestone — not a one-time event

Integration Charter & Terms of Reference

Purpose & Objective

- Ensure seamless integration of Target into FSL while preserving customer trust and operational continuity.
- Accelerate value creation through revenue synergies, cost optimisation, and operational efficiency.
- Align systems and culture to FSL standards — where Target excels, evaluate adoption into FSL.
- **Explicit Value Targets:**
 - Revenue Synergy: \$[] million within 12 months
 - Cost Synergy: \$[] million SG&A savings (offshoring, downsizing, vendor renegotiation) within 12 months
 - []% improvement in Account Margin | Run rate EBITDA Margin over []% / []% in 12/24 months

Target State, Success Criteria & Value KPIs

- **Target State:**
 - Single operating model with standardised processes
 - Integrated IT systems with secure data handling
 - Unified HR policies and talent acquisition aligned to FSL strategy
- **Success Criteria:**
 - Revenue synergy targets achieved
 - Cost optimisation via rightshoring, offshoring, downsizing and vendor renegotiation
 - Brand sunset / rebrand completed within agreed timeline (Phase 2)
 - Compliance and security standards met (e.g. HIPAA, URAC) | Target services integrated into FSL offerings
- **Value KPIs & Measurement Cadence:**
 - Revenue Synergies: Cross-sell and upsell opportunities with FSL Solution Team
 - Cost Synergies: SG&A efficiency through rightshoring, optimisation, offshoring and vendor renegotiation
 - Operational KPIs: Service quality, turnaround times
 - Benefits Funnel: Identified → Committed → Realised (validated by Finance) | Cadence: Monthly

Workstreams

- Sales Organisation
- Business Operations
- HR
- Finance
- Legal/Compliance
- IT/InfoSec
-

- Software/Platform Services
- Facilities & Infra
 - Marketing & Communications
 - Commercial (GCT)

Key Deliverables

- Unified operating model
- Integrated systems and data security compliance
- HR alignment and talent strategy
- Market-facing messaging and brand transition
- GTM Strategy Whitepaper
- Software/Platform assessment & integration

Core Integration Team Structure

- Executive Sponsor: []
- Integration Lead: [Name]
- PMO Lead: [Name]
- Value Realisation Lead: Finance + BU
- Tech / Software Lead: For IT/data security and software platform alignment
- Change/Comms Lead: For HR and cultural integration

Phase-Based Approach

- **Phase 1: Stabilise (Day 0–45)**
 - Continuity & Risk Control, and Day-1 readiness
- **Phase 2: Optimise (Day 46–90)**
 - Integration & Alignment
- **Phase 3: Transform (Day 91–180)**
 - Scale & Long-Term Value | Brand sunset / rebrand and client communication cadence

Governance Model & Reporting Framework

- **Executive Steering Committee:**
 - CEO, CFO, CHRO, Business Sponsor, CDO | Cadence: Monthly or fortnightly
- **Working Steering Committee:**
 - Integration Lead, [PMO], Workstream Owners | Cadence: Weekly execution reviews
 - Mandatory Artefacts: RAID log, Decision log, Change control log, Steering minutes + action tracker
 - Escalation: Workstream Owners → Working SteerCo → Executive SteerCo | Risk Heatmap: monthly
- **Reporting Framework — Executive Summary Layer:**
 - Overall RAG | Top milestones achieved + next | Top risks/issues/dependencies | Decisions needed | Benefits realised vs forecast | KPIs

Key Decisions to Currently Focus On

- Brand sunset / rebrand timing and messaging strategy
- Target-state architecture and system decommission roadmap
- HR integration and talent acquisition strategy
- Market-facing communication plan
- Location strategy for rightshoring/offshoring

Why This Deck Is Structured the Way It Is

C-suite audiences make decisions, not notes. This deck is built on one sequencing principle: WHY → WHO → HOW → WHAT NEXT.

WHY

Slides 2–3

70–90% of M&A deals fail. Not because the strategy was wrong — because the execution was unmanaged.

Slide 2 makes the global case. Slide 3 makes it personal — four Firstsource deals, four failure patterns, six guardrails that now sit inside DRIVE.

WHO

Slide 4

The C-suite needs to know who is accountable before they can evaluate the strategy.

Slide 4 shows the IMO structure: the Global Head reports to the COO. Every workstream has a named lead. The org is the answer to "who runs this?"

HOW

Slides 5–19

DRIVE framework + Governance + Lifecycle + 100-Day Plan + Culture + Pre-Acquisition Intelligence + Charter + Roadmap.

This is the methodology. Every slide answers a different dimension of "how integrations will be run at Firstsource going forward."

WHAT NEXT

Slides 19–20

IMO Roadmap (Now/Soon/Ready) and AI-powered synergy tracking — the two immediate actions required to make this framework operational.

These are not aspirational — they are the specific mandates Deepinder is seeking executive commitment on.

Design principle: Every slide earns its place by answering one question a C-suite member would ask. Slides that couldn't answer a specific question were removed or moved to the appendix.

Building IMO – TeleMedik Test case

Priority Focus Areas — Global Head of M&A Integrations

Informed by: Sohit Bramhavar · 10 July 2026

01

Telemedik IMO Activation

"Telemedik is the newest kid on the block — it is the perfect test bed."

— Sohit Bramhavar

- Stand up IMO charter for Telemedik immediately — DSB as accountable lead
- Replace Gantt-chart tracking with DRIVE lifecycle governance
- Weekly ops SteerCo: Matt, Scott, Shubha, DSB — start next week
- Earn-out construct clarity for Dr. Fernandez documented and agreed

START NOW

02

Single-Point Accountability

"Information asymmetry — some with Matt, some with Scott, some with Dr. Fernandez."

— Sohit Bramhavar

- Map all decision rights: who owns what, by when — no overlap
- RAID log and decision log activated from Day 1 of IMO
- Brand integration: FSL email IDs and brand association plan confirmed
- TOM mapped and operating model ownership assigned within 2 weeks

START NOW

03

Synergy Baseline & Value Tracking

"Revenue shortfall and margin — so many opportunities to extract value from data."

— Sohit Bramhavar

- AI synergy tracker live: cost AND revenue, named owner per line
- WFM practices embedded — FSL scheduling model applied to Telemedik
- Power BI reporting layer: client-level P&L visible within 45 days
- Bucket A cross-sell pipeline structured with CRO — named accounts

START NOW

04

People Risk & Culture

"Attrition is through the roof — no red flag raised unless I proactively asked."

— Sohit Bramhavar

- AI retention risk map: top 30 talent flagged, personal calls this week
- Culture Lead activated — embedded from Day 1, reports to IMO
- Leadership structure announced by Day 30 — zero ambiguity
- Monthly flight-risk report to Sohit — proactive, not reactive

START NOW

05

IMO Mandate & Team Build

"Your involvement should not end at 6 months — be in all those discussions."

— Sohit Bramhavar

- IMO mandate formalised: T-90 pre-deal through BAU handover
- In-flight integrations (Ascensos, SN Sauce) brought under IMO governance
- Team structure confirmed: Culture Lead, Synergy Lead, IT Integration Lead
- IMO included in Ascensos South Africa structure (Anita / Noel)

START SOON 4–12 WKS